# The Basket Team Story

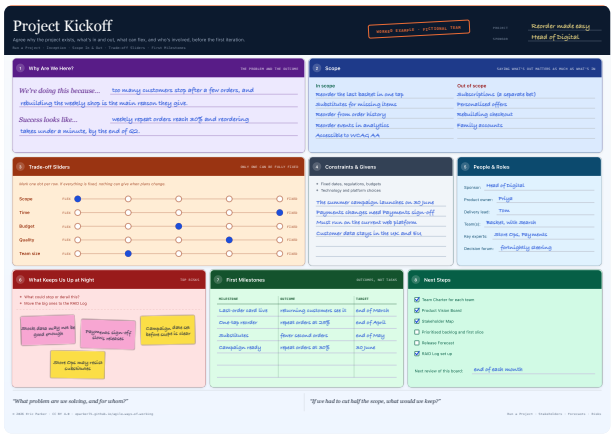
Every worked example in the toolkit, in the order it happened: one fictional team at an online grocery service, from launching in February to closing out in July. Read it as a case study of the tools working together. Each step opens the filled-in board, with a link back to the blank one. Short on time? Read the highlights: twelve moments and what they teach.

Online, with every board full size: eparker71.github.io/agile-ways-of-working/basket-team-story.html

**The cast.** The Basket team: Priya (product owner), Sam and Jo (developers), Alex (tester), Mei (designer), Tom (Scrum Master), and Ravi (developer, from March). Around them: the Head of Digital (sponsor), and the Checkout, Payments, Search & Browse, Store Platform and Warehouse teams. **The goal:** make the weekly shop effortless, so repeat orders rise from 22% to 30%.

## February · Getting started

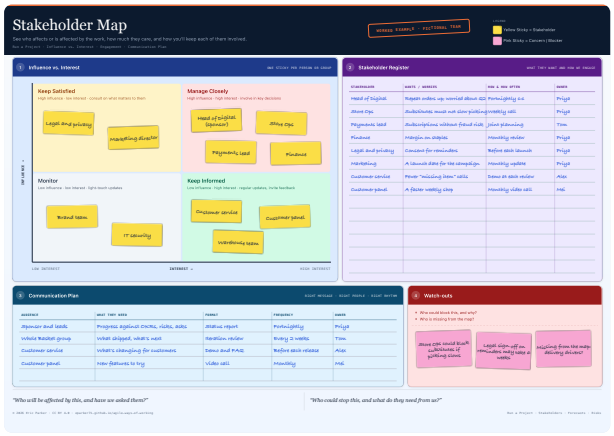
3 Feb




### Project Kickoff

The Head of Digital sponsors “Reorder made easy”: repeat orders from 22% to 30% by the end of June, with only the campaign date fixed.

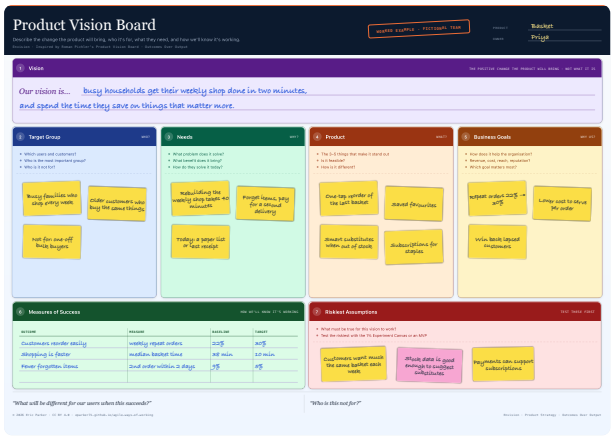
5 Feb




### Stakeholder Map

Eleven stakeholders go on the map. Store Ops and Legal could block it, so they get the closest attention.

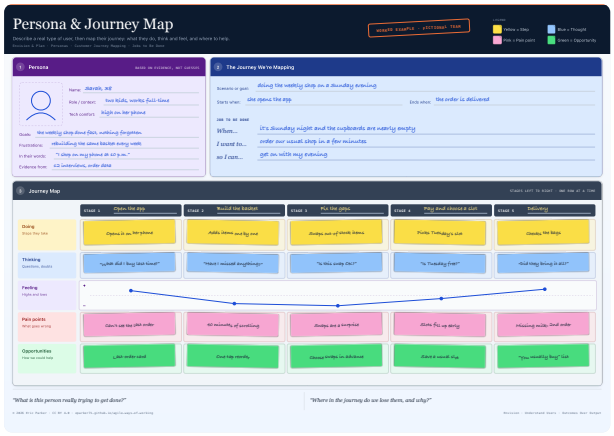
6 Feb




## Product Vision Board

Priya writes the vision: busy households get their weekly shop done in two minutes.

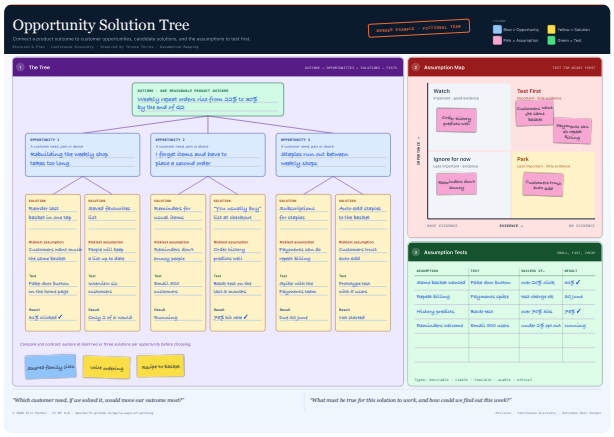
10 Feb




## Persona & Journey Map

Twelve interviews become Sarah, 38, who rebuilds the same basket on her phone every Sunday night.

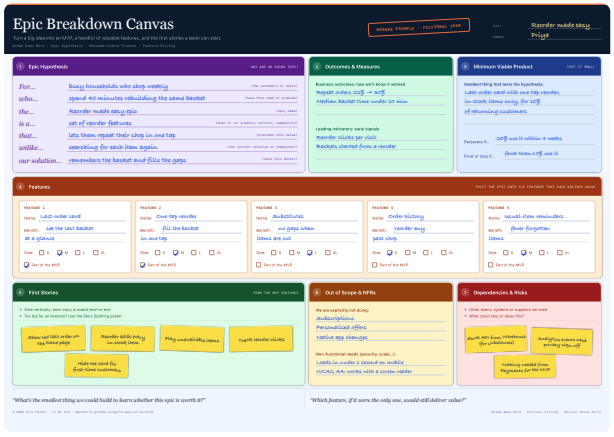
12 Feb




## Opportunity Solution Tree

One outcome, three opportunities, six solutions. A fake-door button shows 31% of customers want one-tap reorder.

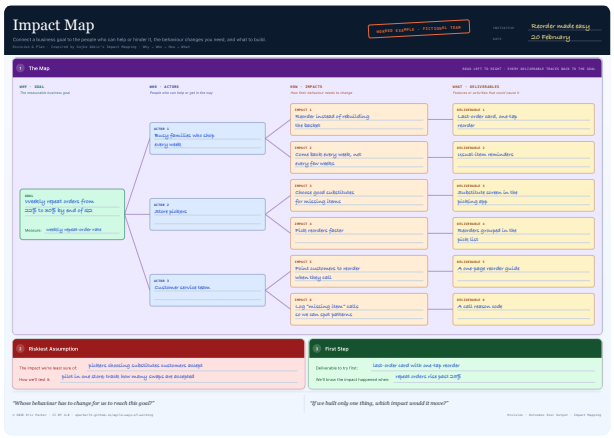
18 Feb




## Epic Breakdown Canvas

The epic as a hypothesis, with an MVP: a last-order card and one-tap reorder for 10% of customers.

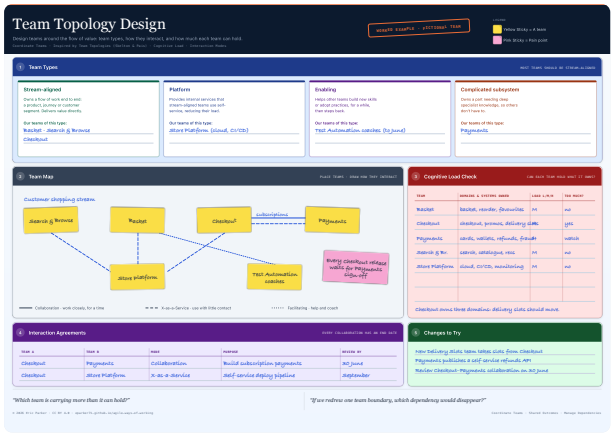
20 Feb




## Impact Map

Families, pickers and customer service each need to behave differently; each gets a deliverable.

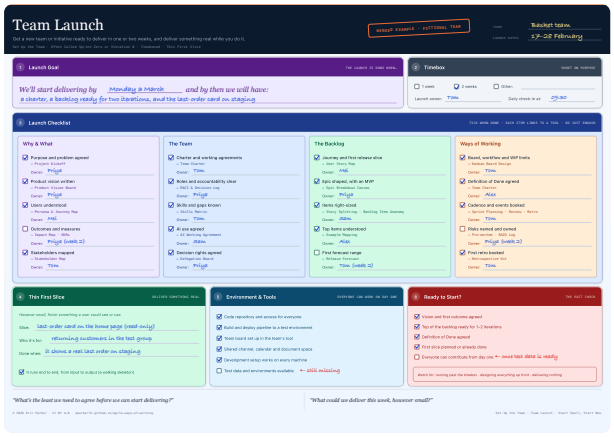
24 Feb




## Team Topology Design

Four teams mapped by type. Checkout is carrying too much, and every release waits for Payments.

17–28 Feb

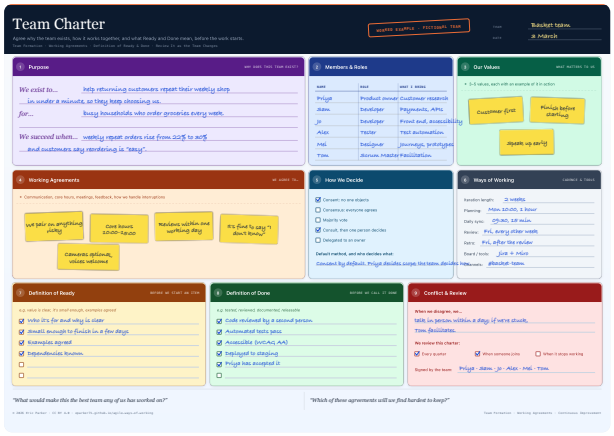



## Team Launch (Sprint Zero)

A two-week launch: charter drafted, backlog ready, and the last-order card running on staging.

# March · Forming the team

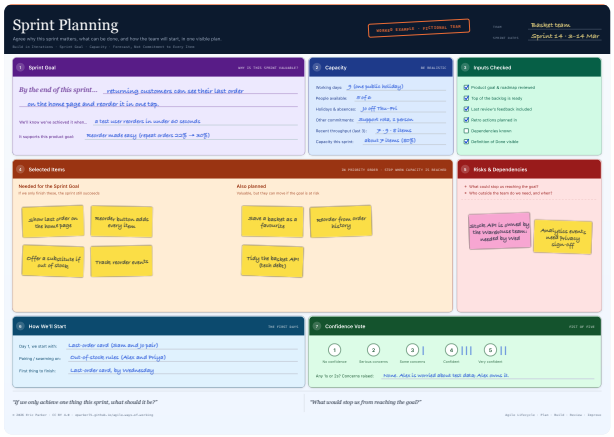
3 Mar




## Team Charter

The Basket team agrees its purpose, values, working agreements and Definitions of Ready and Done.

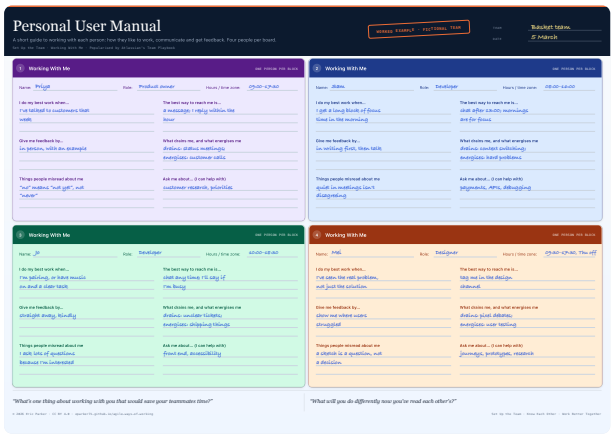
3 Mar




## Sprint Planning

Sprint 14's goal: returning customers see their last order and reorder it in one tap.

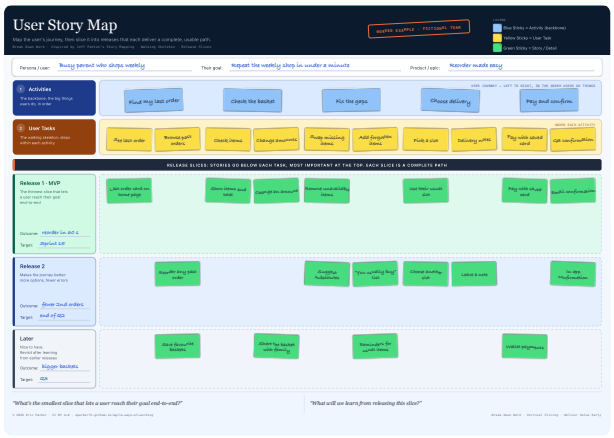
5 Mar




## Personal User Manual

Priya, Sam, Jo and Mei write how to work with them: focus time, feedback, what drains them.

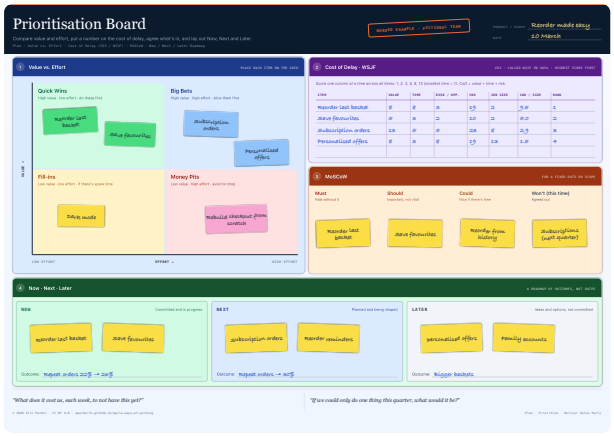
7 Mar




## User Story Map

The reorder journey, sliced into an MVP, a second release and later.

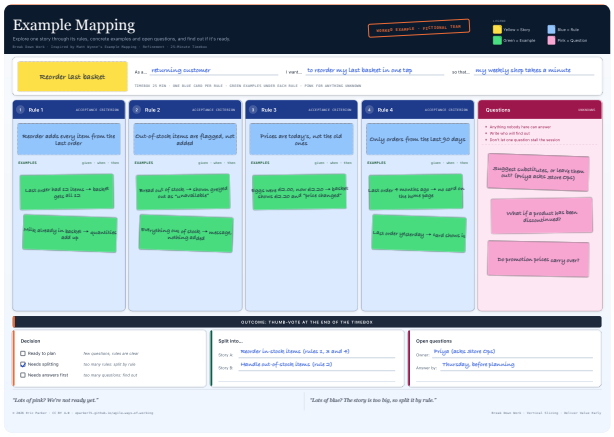
10 Mar




## Prioritisation Board

Cost of delay ranks reorder first and subscriptions third; the Now · Next · Later plan follows.

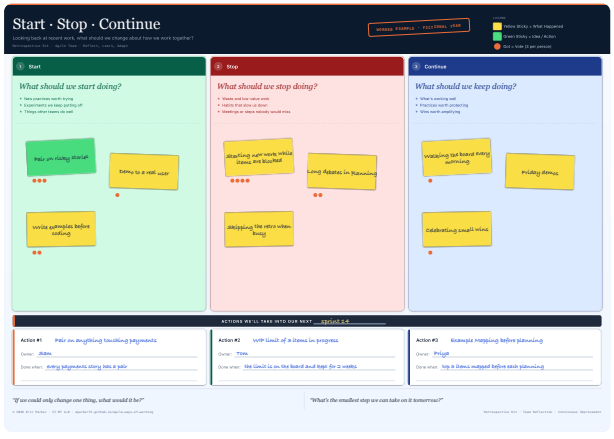
12 Mar




## Example Mapping

“Reorder last basket” has four rules and three open questions, so it's split into two stories.

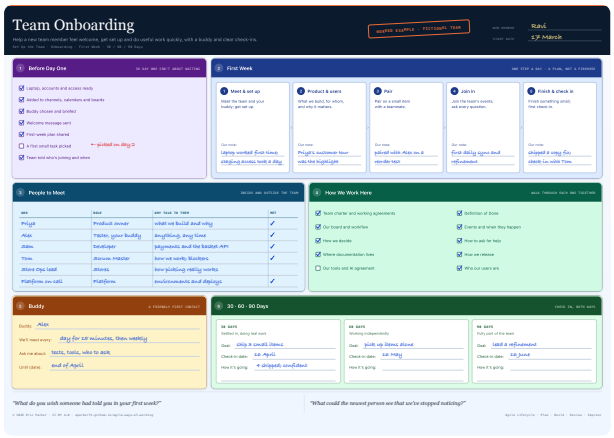
14 Mar




## Start · Stop · Continue

Sprint 14's retro: stop starting new work while items are blocked; try Example Mapping before planning.

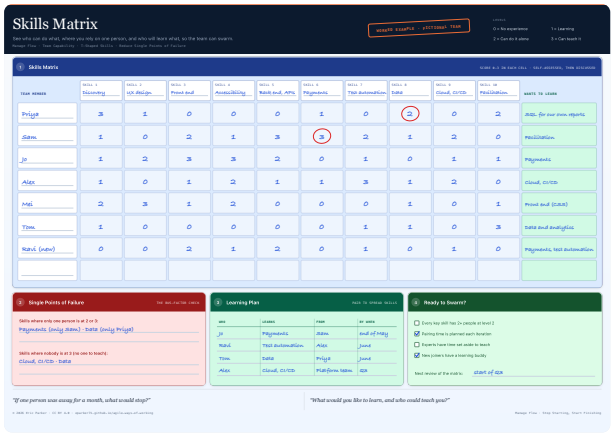
17 Mar




## Team Onboarding

Ravi joins, with Alex as his buddy and a first week that ends with something shipped.

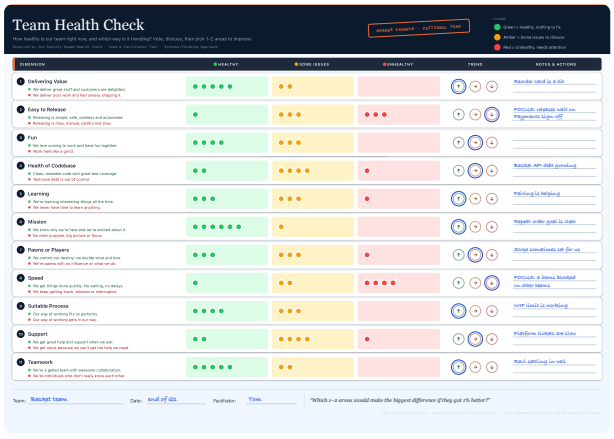
20 Mar




## Skills Matrix

The skills matrix shows two single points of failure: only Sam knows payments, only Priya knows the data.

28 Mar

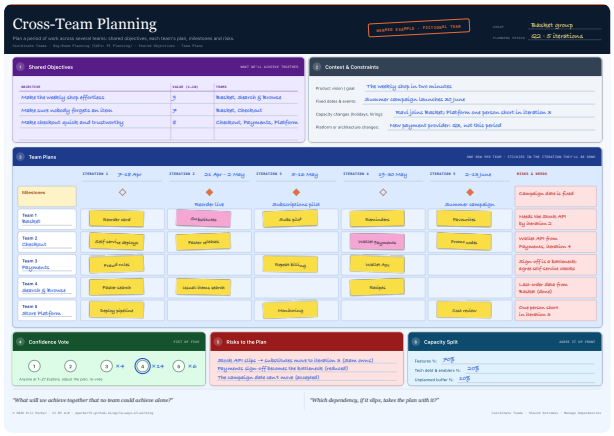



## Team Health Check

End of the quarter: releases and waiting on other teams are the two areas to fix.

# April · Delivering, and the first knocks

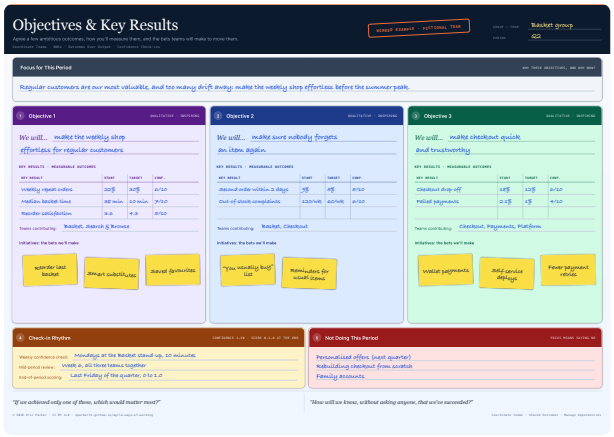
1 Apr




## Cross-Team Planning

Five teams plan the quarter together around three shared objectives; confidence vote: 4.

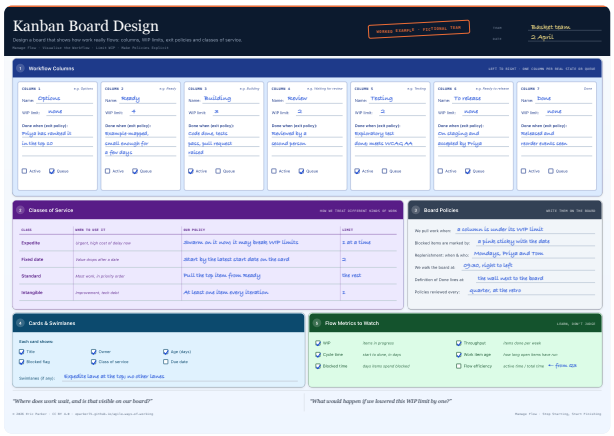
1 Apr




## Objectives & Key Results

Three objectives for Q2, from effortless weekly shops to a quicker, trustworthy checkout.

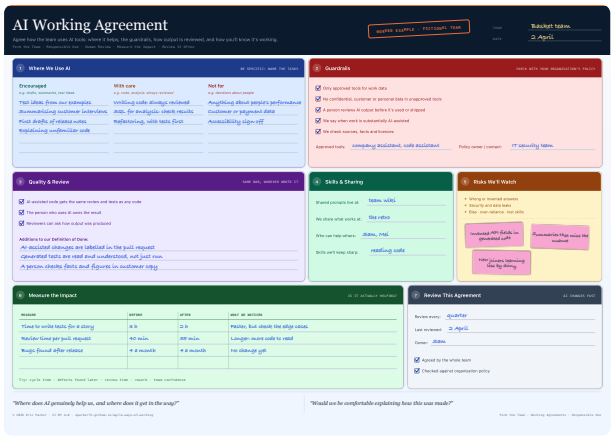
2 Apr




## Kanban Board Design

The team redesigns its board: seven columns, WIP limits and exit policies.

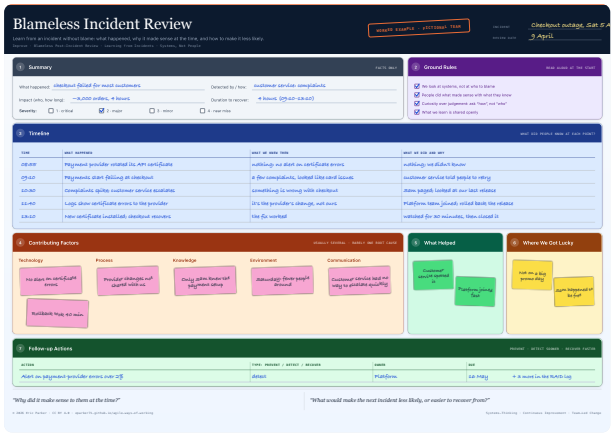
2 Apr




## AI Working Agreement

The team agrees where AI helps, where it's off limits, and how its output is reviewed.

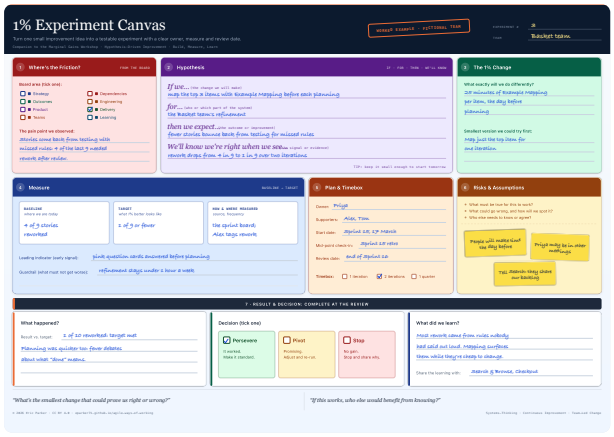
9 Apr




## Blameless Incident Review

Saturday 5 April: checkout fails for four hours. The blameless review finds no alert on certificate errors.

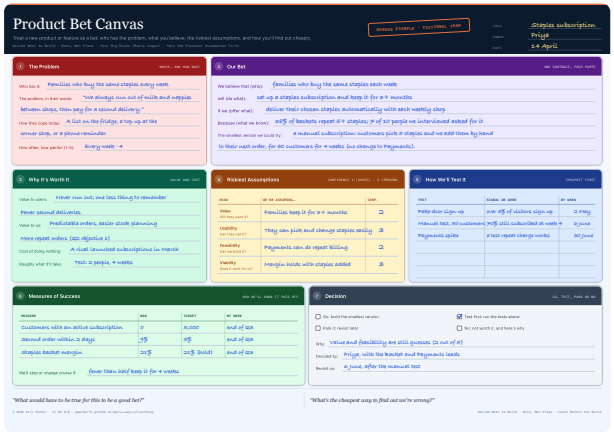
11 Apr




## 1% Experiment Canvas

Example Mapping before planning worked: rework fell from 4 in 9 stories to 1 in 10.

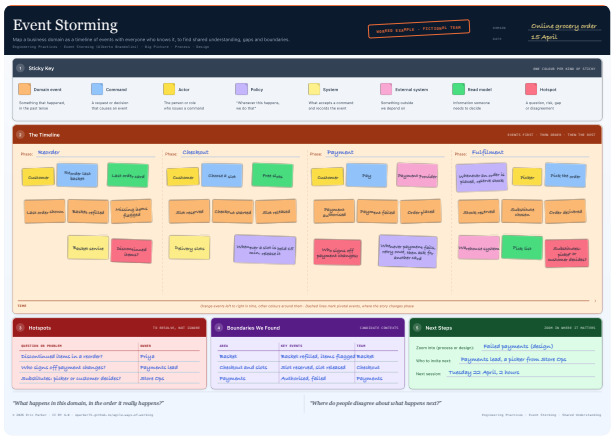
14 Apr




## Product Bet Canvas

The staples subscription bet: test it by hand with 50 customers before building anything.

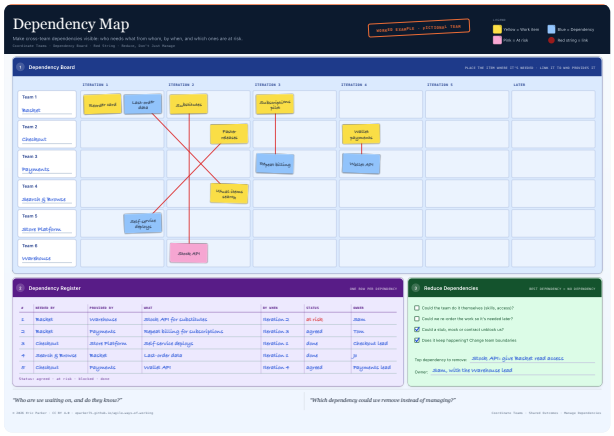
15 Apr




## Event Storming

An order from reorder to delivery, mapped with Store Ops and Payments; three hotspots surface.

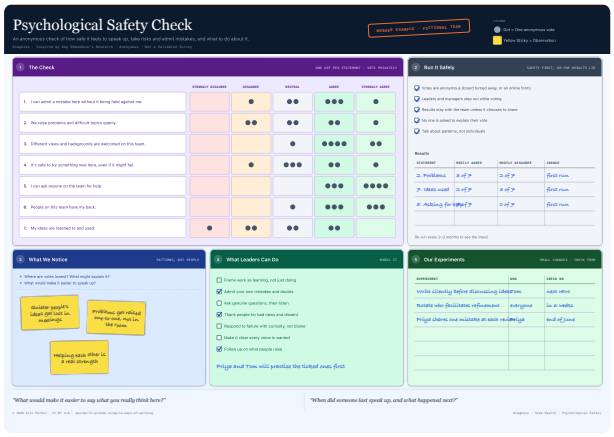
22 Apr




## Dependency Map

Five dependencies across six teams; the Stock API that substitutes need is at risk.

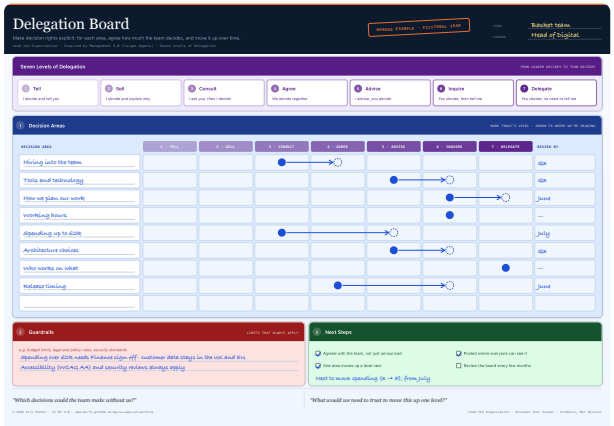
23 Apr




## Psychological Safety Check

An anonymous check: problems are raised one to one, not in the room, so the team tries silent writing.

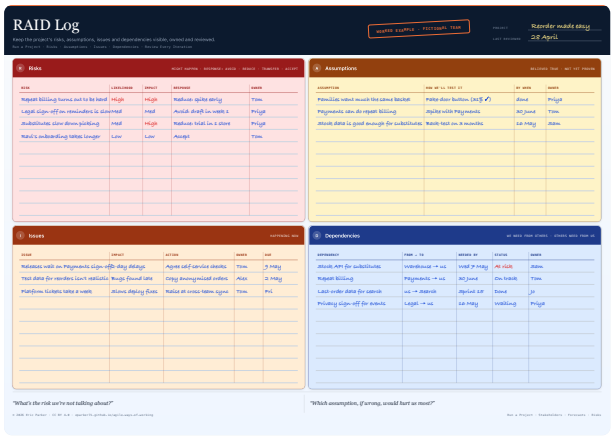
25 Apr




## Delegation Board

Eight decision areas, and where each is heading; spending decisions move to the team in July.

28 Apr

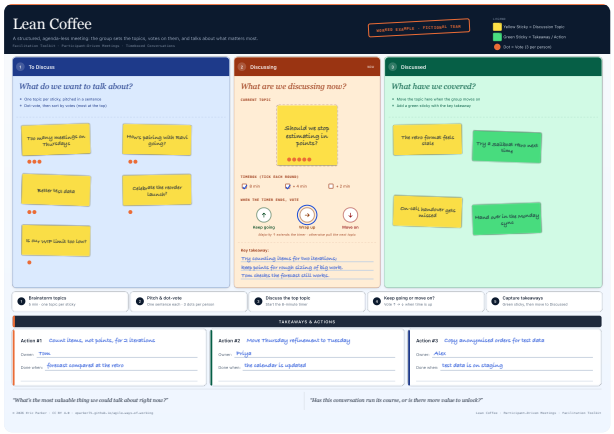



## RAID Log

The RAID log: repeat billing is the biggest risk, the Stock API the dependency at risk.

# May · Under pressure

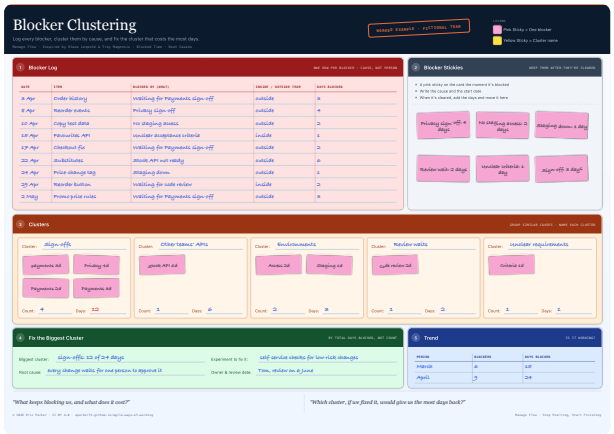
1 May




## Lean Coffee

The team's own agenda: they'll try counting items instead of story points for two iterations.

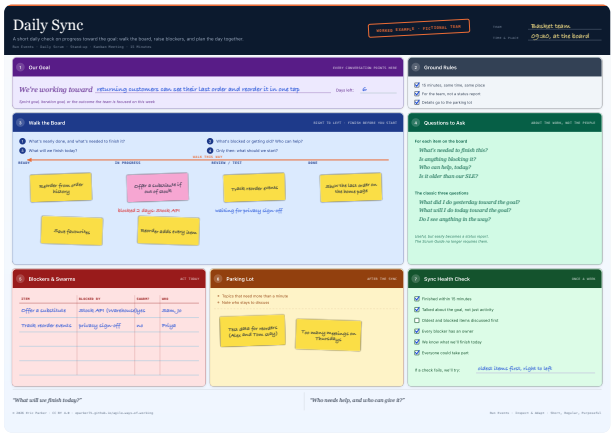
5 May




## Blocker Clustering

April's blockers clustered: sign-offs cost 12 of 24 blocked days, so that's the one to fix.

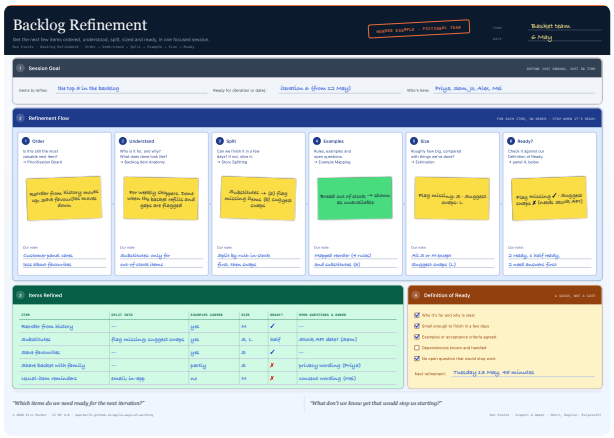
6 May




## Daily Sync

Six days left in Sprint 18. Substitutes are blocked on the Stock API, so two people swarm on it.

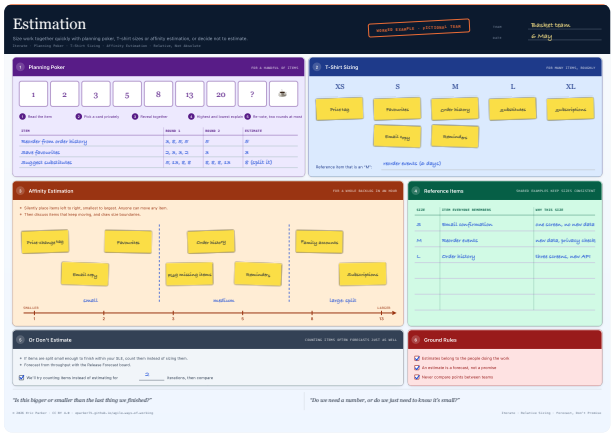
6 May




## Backlog Refinement

Five items taken through order, understand, split, examples, size and ready.

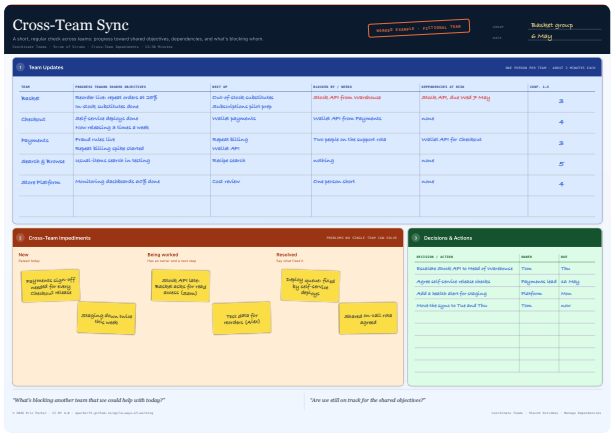
6 May




## Estimation

Planning poker converges on most items; substitutes come out an 8, so they're split.

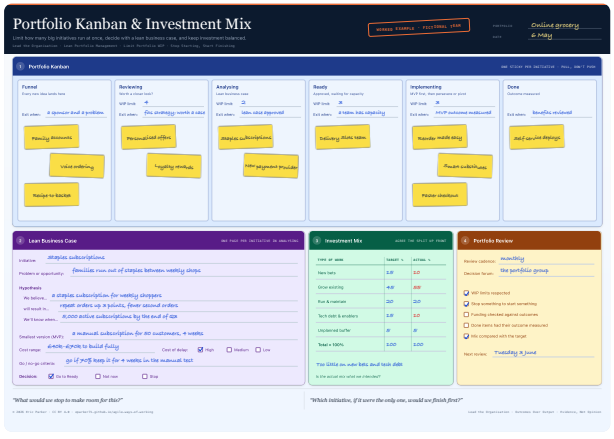
6 May




## Cross-Team Sync

Five teams in 20 minutes: the Stock API is escalated, and release checks are agreed.

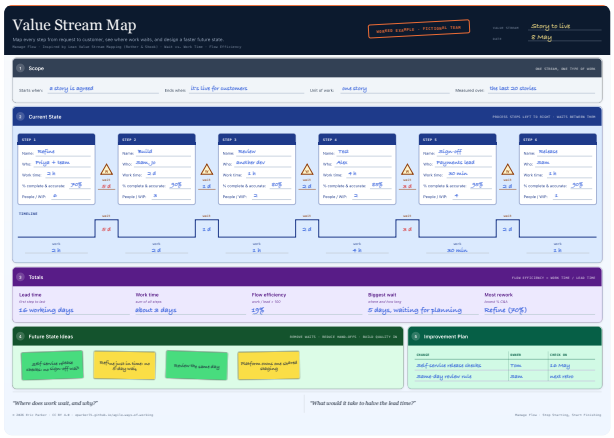
6 May




## Portfolio Kanban & Investment Mix

Twelve initiatives, WIP limits, and an investment mix that's drifted from what was agreed.

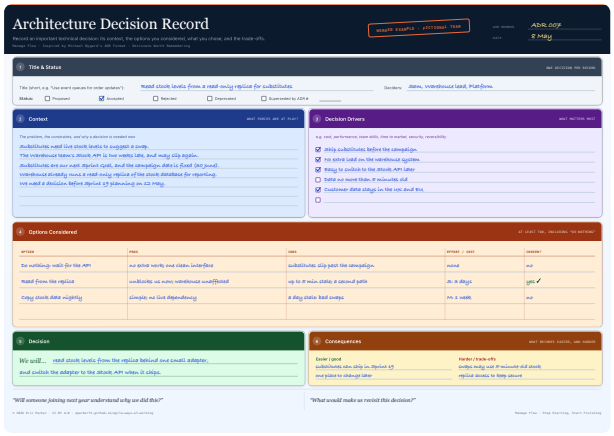
8 May




## Value Stream Map

From story to live takes 16 days, and only 3 of them are work. The longest wait is before building starts.

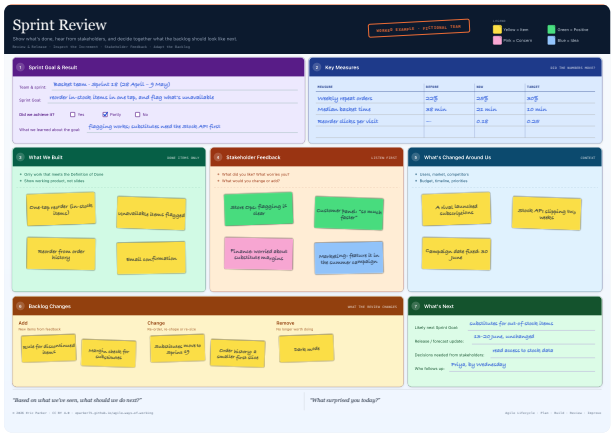
8 May




## Architecture Decision Record

ADR 007: read stock levels from a replica behind an adapter, and switch to the API when it ships.

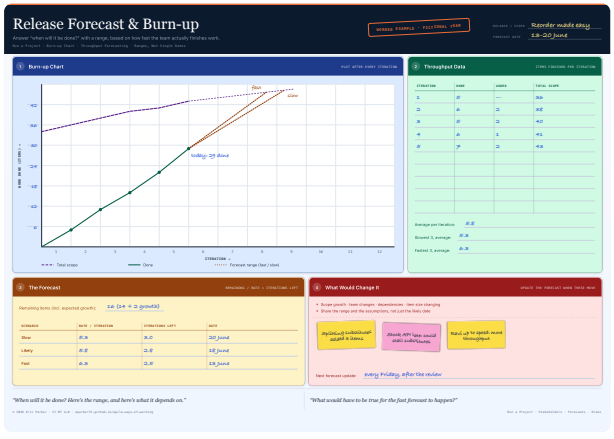
9 May




## Sprint Review

Sprint 18 met its goal partly; stakeholders want substitutes, and Finance worries about margins.

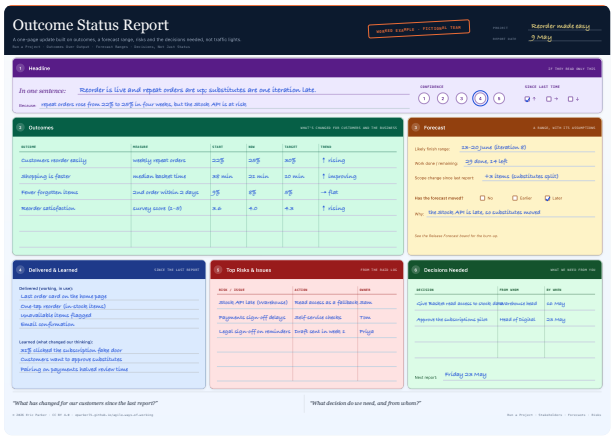
9 May




## Release Forecast & Burn-up

29 items done, 14 left, with scope still growing: likely finish 13–20 June.

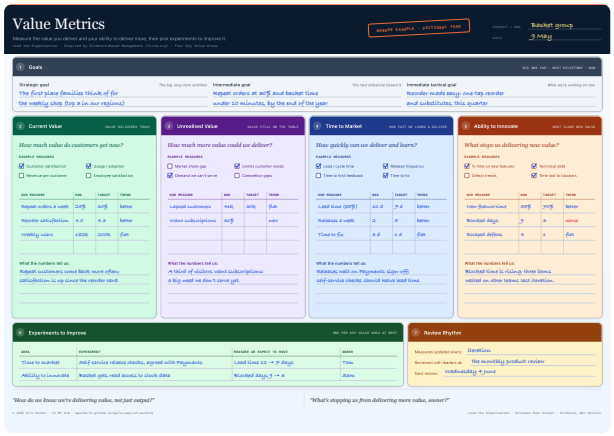
9 May




## Outcome Status Report

Amber: reorder is live and repeat orders are at 25%, but substitutes are an iteration late.

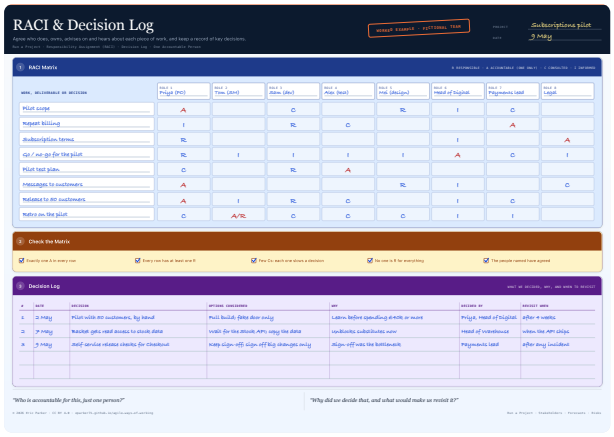
9 May




## Value Metrics

Value metrics across the four areas: faster and more valued, but blocked time is rising.

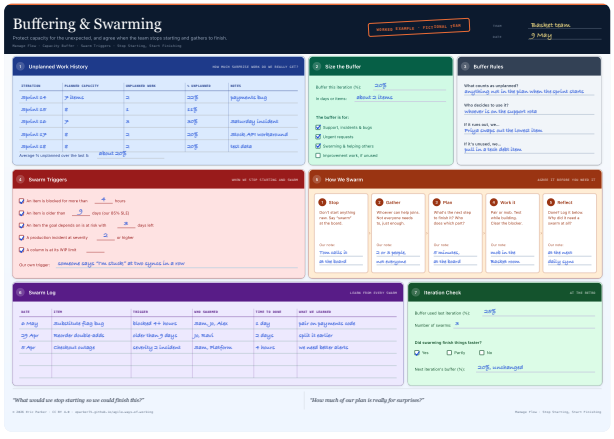
9 May




## RACI & Decision Log

Who does what for the subscriptions pilot, and three decisions logged, including ADR 007.

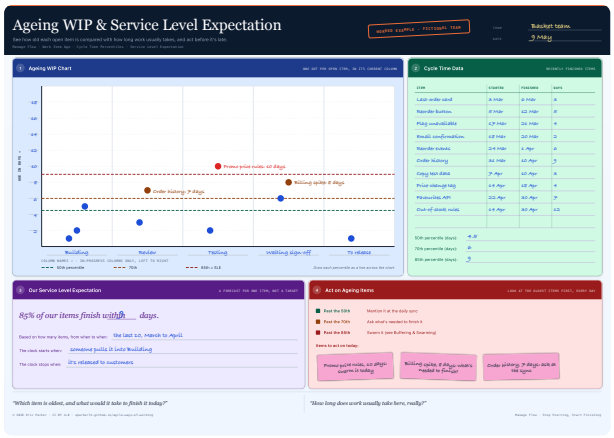
9 May




## Buffering & Swarming

A 20% buffer, sized from five sprints of unplanned work, and swarm triggers with real numbers.

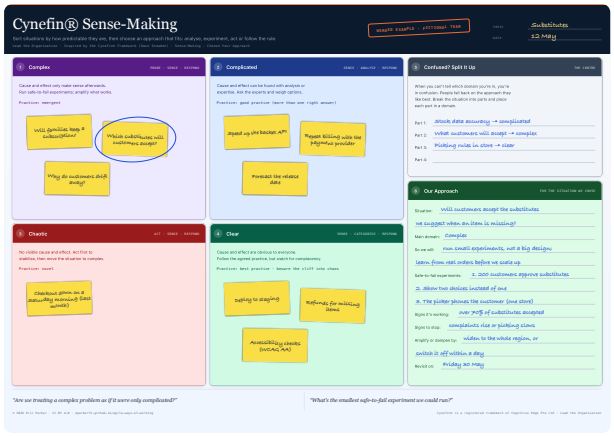
9 May




## Ageing WIP & SLE

Three items are past the 9-day SLE; the oldest gets swarmed today.

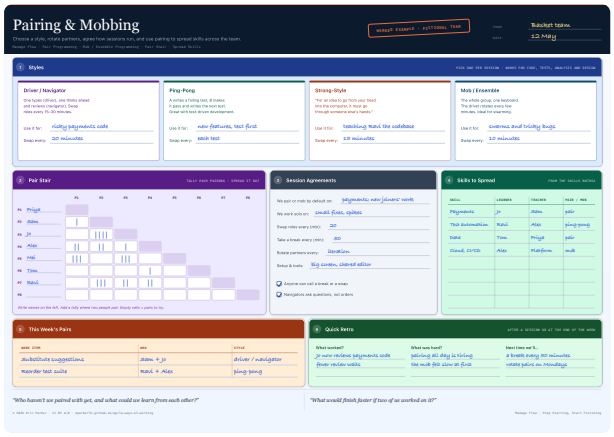
12 May




## Cynefin® Sense-Making

Will customers accept substitutes? It's complex, so three safe-to-fail experiments, not a big design.

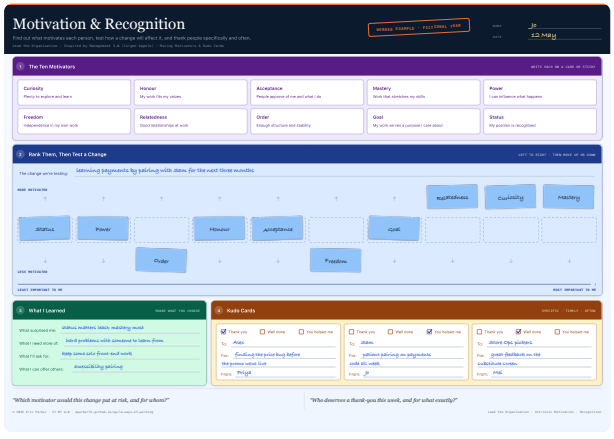
12 May




## Pairing & Mobbing

A pair stair for seven people, and the skills from the matrix spread by pairing.

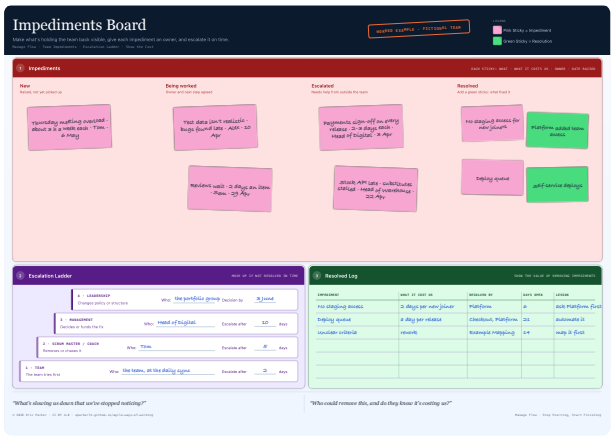
12 May




## Motivation & Recognition

Jo ranks ten motivators against a change: learning payments by pairing with Sam.

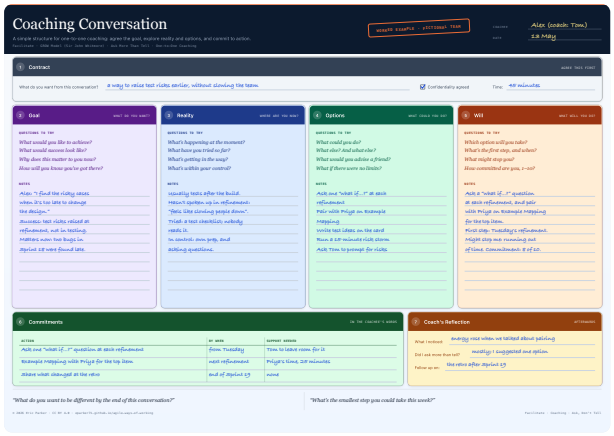
12 May




## Impediments Board

Impediments from new to resolved, with an escalation ladder and what each one cost.

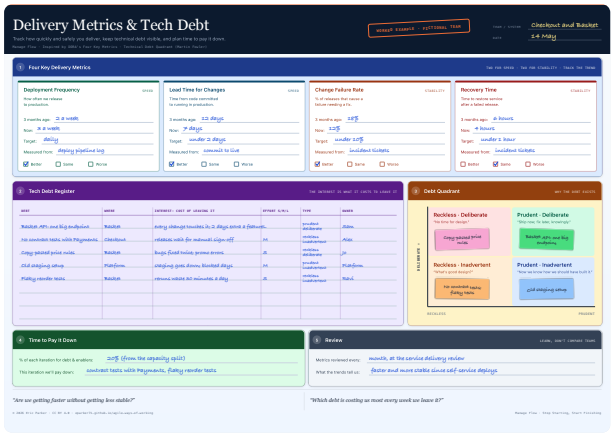
13 May




## Coaching Conversation

Tom coaches Alex on raising test risks earlier; Alex commits to one “what if…?” per refinement.

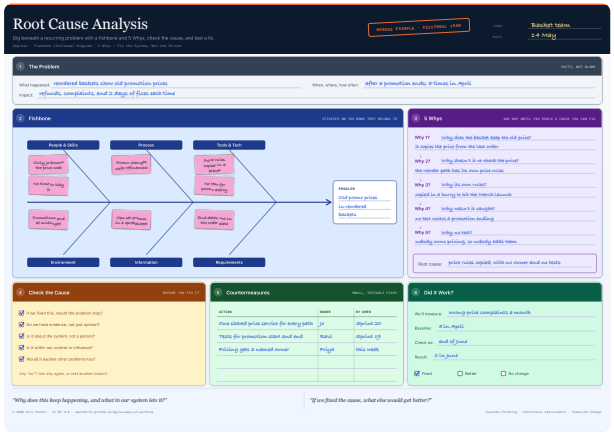
14 May




## Delivery Metrics & Tech Debt

Faster and more stable since self-service deploys; five technical debts placed in the quadrant.

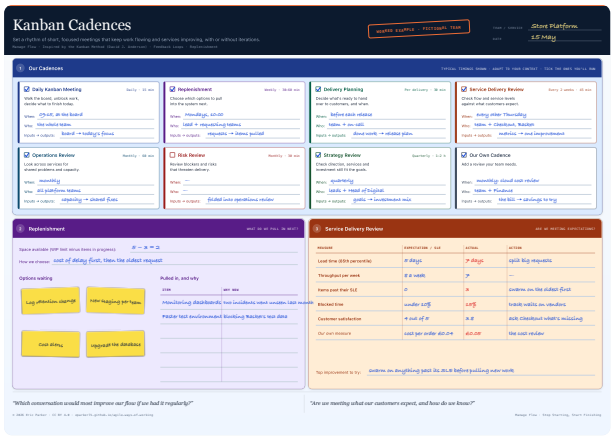
14 May




## Root Cause Analysis

Old promo prices in reordered baskets, traced to copied price rules with no owner.

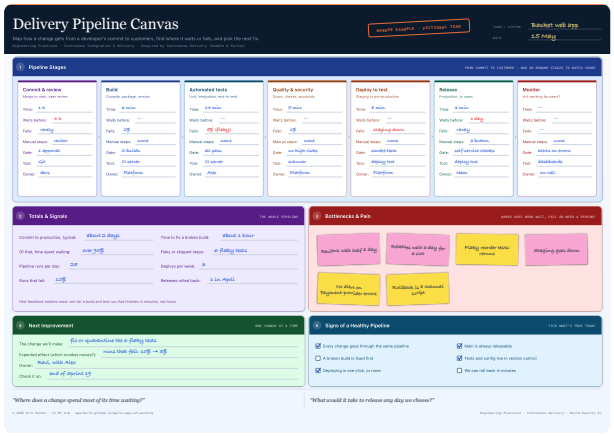
15 May




## Kanban Cadences

Meanwhile the Store Platform team, working in flow, reviews its service against SLEs.

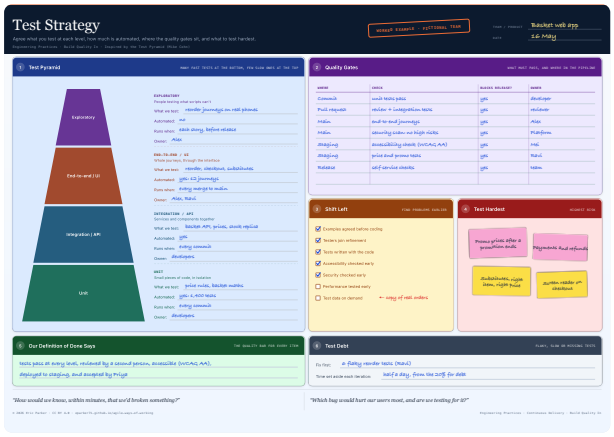
15 May




## Delivery Pipeline Canvas

Seven pipeline stages: changes wait four hours for review and a day for release.

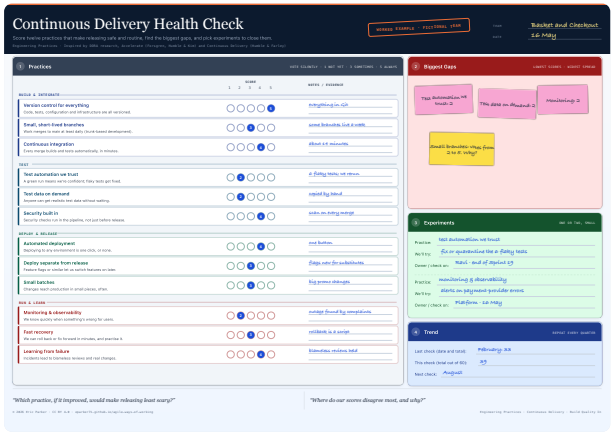
16 May




## Test Strategy

What each level of the pyramid tests, seven quality gates, and where to test hardest.

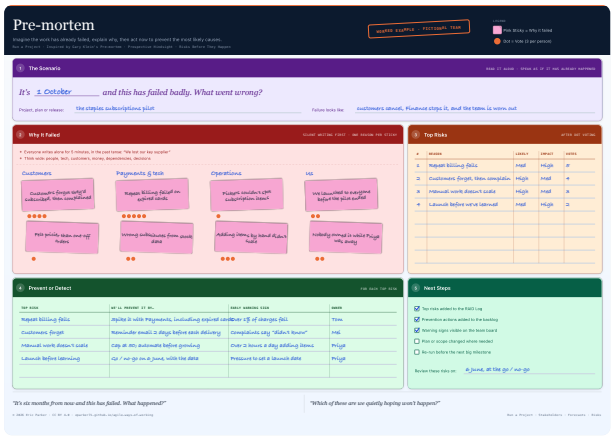
16 May




## Continuous Delivery Health Check

Twelve practices scored: 39 out of 60, up from 33, with flaky tests and monitoring the gaps.

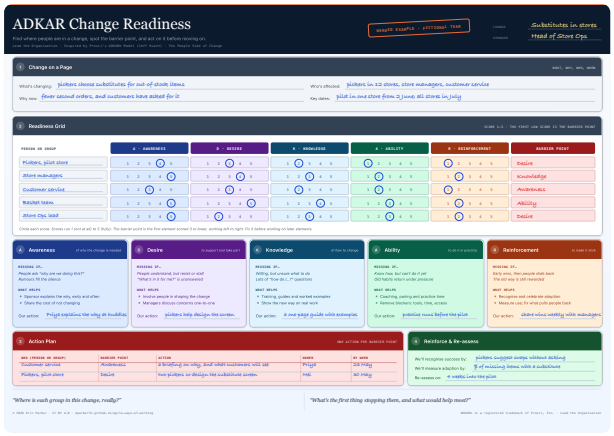
20 May




## Pre-mortem

It's 1 October and the subscriptions pilot has failed. Why? Repeat billing tops the list.

21 May

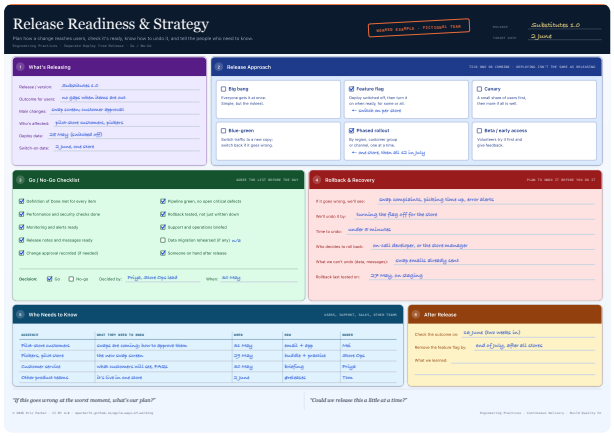



## ADKAR Change Readiness

Rolling substitutes out to store pickers: each group's barrier point, and what to do about it.

# June · Shipping

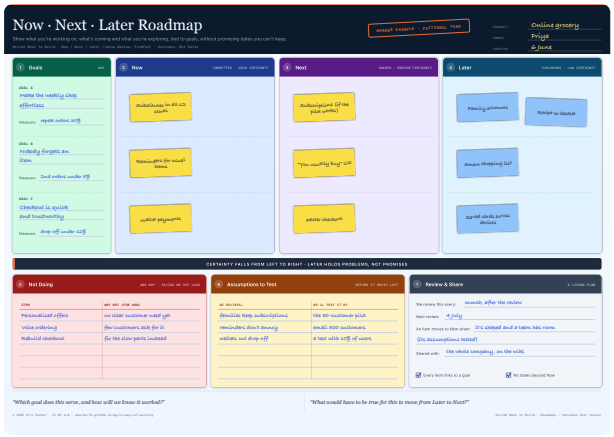
2 June




## Release Readiness & Strategy

Substitutes 1.0 switches on in one store, behind a feature flag, with a tested rollback.

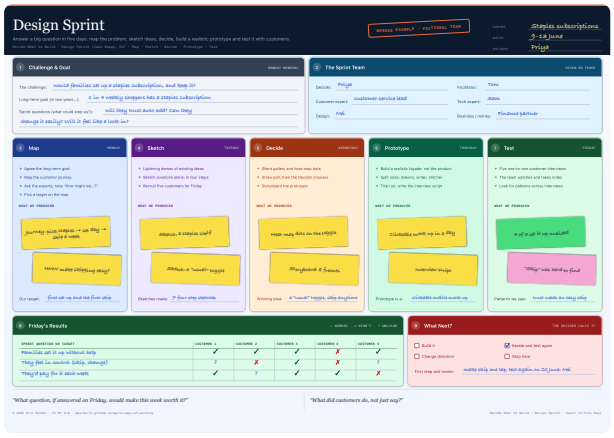
6 June




## Now · Next · Later Roadmap

The roadmap after the pilot: substitutes everywhere now; subscriptions next, if the pilot works.

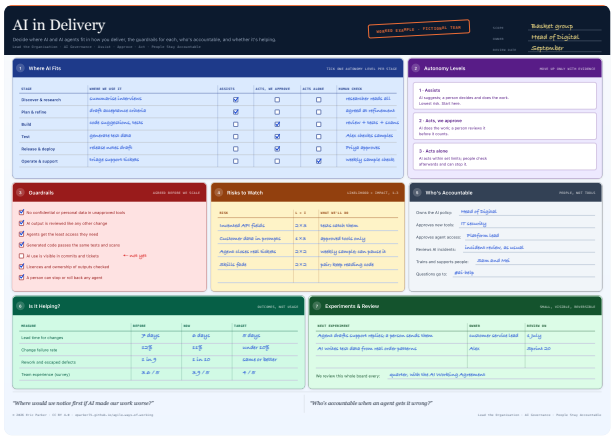
9–13 June




## Design Sprint

Five days on staples subscriptions: four of five customers set it up, but skipping a week was hard.

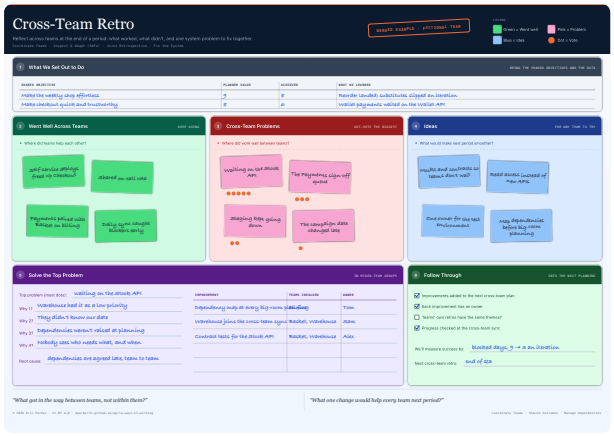
20 June




## AI in Delivery

The group agrees where AI fits at each stage, how much it does alone, and who's accountable.

27 June

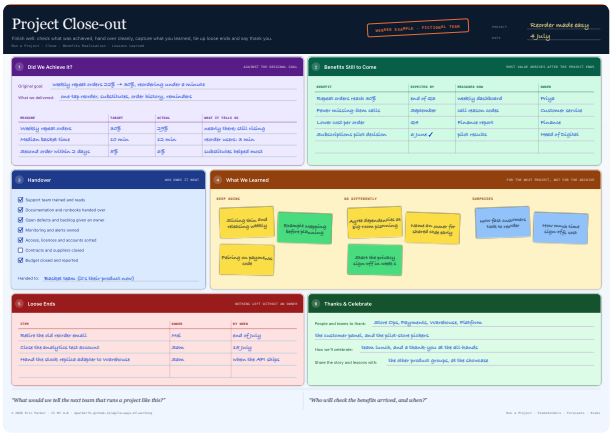



## Cross-Team Retro

Five teams look back on the quarter: the top cross-team problem was waiting on the Stock API.

# July · Finishing well

4 July




## Project Close-out

Repeat orders reached 29%, nearly the 30% target. The team hands over, thanks people and records what it learned.

All names, numbers and events are made up, but the problems are real ones. For the tools grouped by job instead of by date, see the worked examples gallery; for situations rather than a story, see the Scenario Playbook.

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